

cargo traffic at the ports across the country increased by around 3.3% during the first two months of the September 2024 quarter. The rise in cargo traffic at the country's ports is likely to support the industry's top line in the second quarter of the ongoing financial year, per the latest CMIE industry report.

OUTLOOK 2025

The shipping industry in 2025 is poised for transformative changes, driven by advancing technologies, evolving global dynamics, and a strong push towards sustainability. A significant factor shaping its future is the increasing adoption of digitalisation. Advanced technologies such as IoT, blockchain, and AI are expected to enhance supply chain transparency, streamline inventory management, and enable better decision-making by predicting bottlenecks before they arise.

106 | This shift will mark a new era of efficiency in maritime operations. Equally pivotal is the government's focus on strengthening the sector through targeted initiatives. The development of new ports, implementation of favourable policies, and substantial infrastructure investments are set to boost operational efficiency.

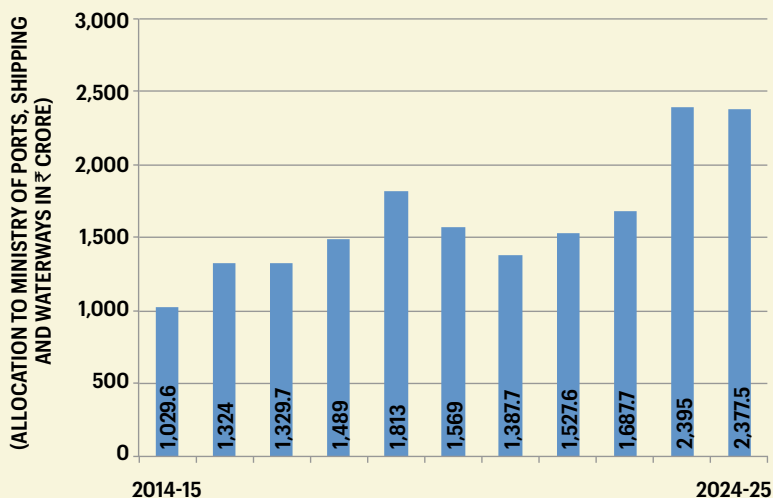
Meanwhile, as per experts, the growth of global trade along with the e-commerce boom will further fuel demand for efficient and reliable transportation. The industry is expected to thrive by meeting this increasing need for swift and dependable goods movement across borders. However, sustainability remains a pressing challenge.

Experts note that in 2025, the sector must embrace cleaner fuels, energy-efficient vessels, and strategies to reduce its carbon footprint, ensuring that its growth aligns with the imperatives of environmental stewardship. Together, these developments promise to

BUDGET TRENDS

➤ There has been a consistent increase in the allocation to the Ministry of Ports, Shipping, and Waterways from FY22 to FY24

➤ The Budget Estimates for FY25 are ₹2,377.5 crore



NOTE: DATA FOR 2024-25 BASED ON BUDGET ESTIMATES, DATA FOR 2023-24 ON REVISED ESTIMATES **SOURCE:** CMIE ECONOMIC OUTLOOK



333%
THE RISE IN
THE M-CAP OF
COCHIN SHIPYARD
IN THE BT500
STUDY PERIOD

redefine the shipping industry's role in the global economy.

With the increasing consumer demand for faster and more convenient delivery options, a robust shipping infrastructure becomes imperative to sustain the growth of the e-commerce industry.

By investing in cutting-edge technologies, the shipping industry can enhance efficiency, reduce costs, and provide exceptional service to e-commerce businesses and their customers.

As CJ Darcl Logistics' Agarwal notes, "Overall, the outlook for the shipping industry in 2025 is positive. By adopting sustainable practices, the sector can position itself as an efficient logistics service provider in the rapidly evolving global marketplace." **BT**

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